Revenue
Cáin agus Custaim na hÉireann
Irish Tax and Customs

Revenue Online Services

Schema Notes

VAT3 – Version 1.6

05/09/2026 onwards

Last Updated	23/07/2026
Document Version	1.6

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0 DOCUMENT INFORMATION

0.1 Synopsis

Notes on the VAT3 v1.6 document type definition for the 5th September 2026 onwards.

This is a draft version and may be subject to further changes.

0.2 Change History

Table 1: Change History

Version Number	Section Affected	Change Description	Date
0.1 (Draft)	All	Document created.	14/03/2014
1.3	0 - 2 APPENDIX 1	Notes added SAMPLE XML FILE updated as per table 2	06/06/2014
1.4	2.1 Appendix 1	Postponed Accounting and Unusual Expenditure added Sample XML file updated as per table 2	14/10/2020
1.5	2.1	Fields servicesto and Postponed Accounting are updated to accept 10 digits. The field Postponed Accounting is now mandatory.	17/02/2025
1.6	2.1	Max length of unusualExpenditureDtl field updated to 400 characters	23/07/2026

1 SCHEMA OVERVIEW

This document contains all the validation rules, which must be passed to enable a successful form uploads to ROS for VAT3, Supplementary VAT3 and Amended VAT3.

These include for each attribute or element:

- Correct data formats
- Maximum and minimum values where applicable

This document should be used as an aid to the VAT3 v1.6 Form schema. It details the data types and defaults for each of the elements and attributes within the schema.

The XML message must be encoded using UTF-8. The first line within the XML message must indicate this. Please see the Sample File in section Appendix 1 – Sample xml file.

2 ELEMENTS

The file will consist of a root VAT3 element.

2.1 VAT3

The VAT3 element has the following attributes:

Table 2 – VAT3 File attributes

Name	Type	Minimum Value/ Length	Maximum Value/ Length	Required (Y/N)	Description / Validation
name	Text Character	1	30	Y	Trading Name. Up to and including 30 characters in length.
regnum	Text Character	8	9	Y	The PPSN (RSI) number of the Employer (length 8 or 9). Required format is 7 numerics (including leading zeros) followed by one or two letters.
filefreq	Numeric	0	3	Y	Filing Frequency: 0 for Bi-Monthly / Repayment Only 1 for Other 2 Four Monthly 3 Bi- Annual
startdate	Date	N/A	N/A	Y	Begin Date of the VAT3 Period (DD/MM/YYYY).
enddate	Date	N/A	N/A	Y	End Date of the VAT3 Period (DD/MM/YYYY).
type	Numeric	0	2	Y	Type of VAT3 Return: 0 for an Original VAT3 Return 1 for a Supplementary VAT3 Return 2 for Amended VAT3 Return
sales	Numeric	0	999999999	Y	VAT on Sales in Euro only. (No cent) Maximum of €999,999,999
purchs	Numeric	0	999999999	Y	VAT on Purchases in Euro only. (No cent) Maximum of €999,999,999
goodsto	Numeric	0	999999999	Y	Total goods to other EU countries in Euro only. (No cent) Maximum of €999,999,999
goodsfrom	Numeric	0	999999999	Y	Total goods from other EU countries in Euro only. (No cent) Maximum of €999,999,999
servicesto	Numeric	0	9999999999	Y	Total services to other EU countries in Euro only. (No cent) Maximum of €9,999,999,999
servicesfrom	Numeric	0	999999999	Y	Total services from other EU

Name	Type	Minimum Value/ Length	Maximum Value/ Length	Required (Y/N)	Description / Validation
					countries in Euro only. (No cent) Maximum of €999,999,999
formversion	Numeric	1	1	Y	Must be equal to '1' for this version of the file format.
language	Text Character	1	1	Y	Language through which the return is being filed: - E for English, or - G for Irish
currency	Text Character	1	1	Y	The currency through which the return is being filed: - E for Euro, or This should always be 'E' for Euro as ROS will not accept VAT3 Returns in Punt.
unusualExpenditure	Text Character	1	1	N	Flag indicating presence of unusual expenditure: - Y for yes - N or no entry for no
unusualExpenditureAmt	Numeric	0	999999999	N	Amount of unusual expenditure Not permitted if unusualExpenditure field is not set to Y
unusualExpenditureDtl	Text	0	400	N	Description of unusual expenditure Not permitted if unusualExpenditure field is not set to Y
postponedAccounting	Numeric	0	9999999999	Y	Value of goods imported under Postponed Accounting (net plus carriage, insurance and freight (CIF)) If a value is entered for postponedAccounting, values of sales and purchs should include values greater than 0.

3 APPENDIX 1 – SAMPLE XML FILE

Below is a sample XML VAT3 file;

```
<?xml version="1.0" encoding="UTF-8" standalone="yes"?>

<VAT3 currency="E" name="Trade Name" regnum="1234567T" startdate="01/01/2021" enddate="28/02/2021"
sales="999999999" purchs="999999999" goodsto="999999999" goodsfrom="999999999"
servicesto="9999999999" servicesfrom="999999999"  type="0" filefreq="0" formversion="1" language="E"
postponedAccounting="9999999999" unusualExpenditure="Y" unusualExpenditureAmt="999999999"
unusualExpenditureDtl="Unusual Expenditure"/>
```